

What A-POS costs to run

A plain-English guide to when - and whether - you would ever pay

04 September 2026

The short answer

Nothing. Your system runs on free services, and at your expected volume it will keep doing so for years. Your backups are automatic and also free. There is one optional upgrade at about \$25 a month (roughly PKR 700) and this document explains exactly what would make it worth paying - and roughly when.

Where your information lives

Two things have to be paid for in any system like this: somewhere to keep the information, and somewhere to run the software. Yours uses Supabase for the first and Cloudflare for the second. Both have free levels that are not trials - they do not expire, and they do not ask for a card.

Everything a shop records - every sale, purchase, customer balance and expense - is stored on Supabase, not on the computer in the shop. That is why a till can be closed, a laptop can break, and nothing is lost.

What the free level gives you

	Included free	What that means for you
Storage	500 MB	Years of trading (see below)
Monthly data transfer	5 GB	The busiest limit - explained below
Staff accounts	Unlimited	Never a cost
Automatic backups	Not included	We solved this separately, free

How quickly your information actually grows

One recorded sale - the date, the customer, every item, the prices and the profit - takes up about the same space as a short text message. The table below works out how long the free 500 MB lasts at three different levels of trade, and includes a generous allowance for purchases, expenses and returns on top.

If you record	Per year	Free storage lasts
50 sales a day	about 18 MB	over 25 years
100 sales a day	about 36 MB	about 13 years
300 sales a day	about 110 MB	about 4 years

Even allowing for the extra space the database uses to keep everything fast, storage is not something you need to think about. If you ever did fill it, the next level up holds 8 GB - sixteen times more.

The limit you would actually reach first

Every time someone opens the app, it downloads the shop's records so it can show reports, ledgers and balances instantly. Early on that is a tiny amount. As years of history build up, each of those downloads gets larger, and the free level allows 5 GB of downloading per month across everybody.

A realistic estimate for a four-shop business recording about 100 sales a day:

	Downloaded per month	Against the 5 GB free
First 6 months	about 1.5 GB	comfortable
After 1 year	about 4 GB	getting close
After 2 years	about 8 GB	over the limit

So the honest answer to 'when would I have to pay?' is: not now, and most likely not this year - but somewhere between one and two years of steady trading, this is the line you would cross first.

You would have two choices at that point

1. Pay about \$25 a month, which raises this allowance fifty-fold and would never be reached.
2. Have the software changed so it only loads the current period instead of the whole history. This is a one-off piece of work, after which the free level would comfortably last again.

Your backups - already handled, at no cost

Supabase only keeps automatic backups for paying customers. Rather than pay for that, or ask you to remember to download anything, the system now takes a complete copy of your database every night, on its own, and keeps the last 90 days.

- It runs at 2am, after the shops have closed and the day has been settled.
- You do not press anything. There is nothing to remember and nothing to store yourself.
- If a copy ever came back empty, the process reports a failure rather than quietly saving nothing.
- Any of the last 90 nights can be restored in full.

This covers the one thing that genuinely matters: if information were ever deleted by accident, last night's copy exists and does not live inside the same account as the original.

One small thing to know

A free Supabase project goes to sleep if it is not used for a whole week, and someone has to wake it with a single click. A shop trading normally will never see this. It could only happen over a long closure - so if you shut for a week or more, expect the first person back to need that one click.

What you might choose to pay for anyway

	Cost	Do you need it?
Supabase Pro	\$25 / month	Not yet
Your own web address	about PKR 3,500 / year	Optional, for appearance
Running the software	Free	No cost expected
Sending bills by email	Free up to ~3,000/month	Only if you want it

In one paragraph

You are on free services that are built to stay free at your size. Storage will not be a problem for over a decade. Your nightly backups are automatic and cost nothing. The single thing that would eventually cost money is the amount of information moved each month, and that is one to two years away at a steady hundred sales a day - at which point it is either about PKR 7,000 a month, or a one-off change to the software. Nothing needs deciding today.